



Creative tourism for the development of tourism entrepreneurship in Latin America

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Abstract Innovation and entrepreneurship in tourism are favourable for the development of a diversified offer and according to the visitor's demands. At the same time, both are capable of generating new tourism benefits for the local economy with the emergence of new businesses that will generate jobs. These entrepreneurial companies offer tourism packages that include community activities based on local culture and history. The activities motivate the visitor, and the visitor becomes involved in the cultural experiences offered by the destinations; from that moment on, what is known as “creative tourism” is generated. The objective of this study is to analyse creative tourism for tourism business ventures in Latin America. A systematic review of the literature on creative tourism, which favours the development of tourism entrepreneurship, has been carried out. The search process followed the guidelines of the Prisma protocol, and the Scopus, WoS and ProQuest databases were used to carry it out. The results revealed that 20 papers were included in the review; the majority (10) presented a qualitative methodology, while the year 2021 presented the largest number of publications referring to creative tourism. It was found that there is little literature on creative tourism and tourism entrepreneurship as aspects examined together. On the other hand, it was established that investment in tourism favours entrepreneurship through the development of creative tourism. The most used tourism strategies in Peru, Brazil and Chile were the Poverty Reduction and Alleviation Project and Haku Wiñay, as well as workshops, book presentations, forums, talks and conferences. It was concluded that creative tourism plays an important role in the creation and development of tourism ventures in the towns, localities and cultural spaces of a country. In this way, the development of better tourism infrastructures and the obtaining of greater investments are promoted.

Keywords: creative tourism, tourism entrepreneurship, development, strategies

1. Introduction

There is a broad debate on how to stimulate the regeneration of urban and rural areas, particularly those actions that favour the sustainable development of the local and national economy. One of the sectors that efficiently contributes to this purpose is tourism. In this sense, it should be noted that culture and creativity are fundamental parts of tourism since they allow the implementation of creative strategies to achieve the aforementioned sustainable development (Díaz-Pompa, 2022; Díaz, 2023).

From a general point of view, tourism has experienced great advances. Different countries have taken advantage of the development of their cultural heritage, which, according to the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO, 2021), represents the totality of monuments, among which sculptures, paintings, or different archaeological works are included, in addition to a series of independent or group constructions that have historically recognized universal value.

Cultural tourism materializes in the cultural heritage of any nation, which can be classified into tangible heritage and intangible heritage. This heritage provides a competitive advantage to countries and a particularity that differentiates them from others (Prada-Trigo, 2018). In that sense, its insertion in the tourism market occurs through an offer of creative tourism, which is articulated with cultural tourism by valorizing heritage sites. When creativity is added to tourism, it becomes a common diversification strategy, especially concerning cultural tourism (Richards, 2020; Mansilla, 2021). This is achieved by creating new events and festivals, as well as renovating old ones more creatively and attractively for tourists.

In Latin America, creative tourism has not been included in many of the studies conducted on the subject; although this type of tourism has considerable advantages, attention to creative tourism has focused on European countries because their economy has a destination development model based on strategies for the massification of cultural tourism (Dias et al., 2020). Similarly, the aspect of creativity in tourism has rarely been explored in developing nations since little research has been conducted in this field (García-Villaverde et al., 2020). This situation is accentuated in South America, where very few studies related to tourism destinations have been conducted (Pikkemaat et al., 2019).



In Latin America, creative tourism has become a social and economic alternative that allows SMEs to undertake innovative services for local, national, and foreign tourists. In addition, it helps solve the problems generated by industrial tourism, such as inequalities, social fragmentation, displacement, and marginalization. To this end, it uses a cultural element, whose protagonists are the community and its members, using creative development strategies that foster a creative atmosphere, thus making places attractive to consumers and visitors (Castillo-Reina and Cruz, 2022).

Various authors have defined the concept of "creative tourism." Richards and Raymond (2000) were among the first to describe it, highlighting that this type of tourism enables travelers to develop their creative potential through active participation in experiences at the destinations they visit. This initial definition sparked numerous others that further enriched the concept and meaning of creative tourism. According to Mazarrasa (2016), creative tourism emerged as a way to innovate in the tourism industry. Embedded within cultural tourism, its goal is to cater to the needs of modern tourists, who seek unique sensations and aspire not only to observe destinations but also to engage with and feel part of the local community.

This form of tourism is closely linked to cultural tourism. While both rely on culture as the foundation for their activities, creative tourism places the tourist at the center of the cultural experience, encouraging proactive involvement in the activities offered (Sofield et al., 2017; Alberca, 2019). In contrast, cultural tourism often involves the interpretation of culture by another party, typically a guide, which is not the case in creative tourism. Here, tourists actively participate in and contribute to the experiences themselves (Dias et al., 2020).

Creative tourism is not associated with mass travel, which does occur in cultural tourism. In contrast, it aims for experiences to be personalized; hence, one of its characteristics consists of "experiencing" instead of simply "seeing" or "contemplating" (Serrano-Leyva et al. 2021). The essence of creative tourism is the activities and experiences of the tourist, which are related to personal fulfilment and self-expression. These active experiences allow visitors to put their creativity into practice, actively participating in situations and learning experiences specific to the vacation destination where they are carried out (Marujo et al., 2021).

Currently, some very important local factors are involved in the development of creative tourism, namely, enterprising and creative people, the environment, processes and creative packages (Muhamad et al., 2021). Palenčíková and Csapó (2021) further emphasize that in tourism, creativity is tied to offering visitors authentic and distinctive products and experiences. These goals are achieved through cocreation between visitors and hosts at tourism destinations, leveraging the inherent creative capital of destinations.

Finally, it should be noted that the development of creative tourism is closely related to the interest that tourists or visitors have in more participatory tourism activities and to the debate on issues related to sustainability since unsustainable consumption practices are observed in cultural tourism, which damage the environment and local communities; this can be seen in the gentrification of spaces and the commodification of cultural heritage (Silva et al., 2021).

Tourism activity in all its modalities involves diverse activities in which the creativity of those who provide such services can be exploited; this favours entrepreneurship because, by increasing the interactions between such providers and the tourist, new opportunities are generated to incorporate different and novel tourism products (Mansilla et al., 2021). Magadán and Rivas (2018) noted that tourism industries are constantly changing due to new global challenges, which force companies to adapt to accelerated and discontinuous environments. Given this situation, tourism markets present rapid growth, which is why the creativity of the tourism supplier is an essential condition for positioning the company in the market. Thus, creativity is evident when the tourism supplier is able to anticipate the needs and desires of travelers to propose new destinations, activities, and novel services that had not previously been provided (Varotsis, 2022; Castillo-Reina and Cruz, 2022).

Notably, creative entrepreneurship in tourism contributes to the existence of socioeconomic exchange in tourist destinations; in addition, its purpose is to further involve environmental and cultural aspects and experiences related to heritage. Amid this reality, local communities play a fundamental role because through them, it is possible to contact nature and its traditions (Gambarota and Lorda, 2017; UNESCO, 2023). The totality of these contextual links opens up socioeconomic opportunities for various creative activities to succeed in developing. In this sense, SMEs play an important role, as together with communities, they can offer innovative and creative tourism products for local and national development (Mareque et al., 2021).

Now, it is necessary to examine how creative tourism and the application of its strategies in Latin American countries favour tourism entrepreneurship and achieve excellent results for local and national economies. In this sense, a systematic review of the literature was proposed, for which the following research questions were established: How do creative tourism and its strategies favour the development of tourism entrepreneurship in Latin America? What is the state of academic research on creative tourism strategies and tourism entrepreneurship in Latin America? This study aimed to analyse creative tourism for tourism entrepreneurship in Latin America.

2. Materials and Methods

A systematic review with a qualitative approach was carried out following the guidelines of the PRISMA protocol (Rethlefsen et al., 2021; Fernández-Chinguel, 2019). The search process is presented in the PRISMA flowchart (Figure 1) to locate the documents containing the most relevant information to the object of study. The objective of this study was to analyse

creative tourism for tourism business entrepreneurship in Latin America. The research questions guiding the review were as follows: how does creative tourism favour the development of tourism entrepreneurship in Latin America, and what is the state of academic research on creative tourism and tourism entrepreneurship?

As part of the search strategy, the title, abstract, and keywords were considered, and the combinations "creative tourism" AND/OR "tourism entrepreneurship" AND/OR "Latin America" were used as Boolean operators. The inclusion and exclusion criteria applied were as follows: the former included empirical studies, articles, and gray literature published between 2014 and 2024, written in Spanish, English, or Portuguese, and of free access; those articles that did not meet the criteria of methodological quality, written in a language other than those mentioned, that do not provide results relevant to the research question and that were of restricted access were excluded (Pineda et al. 2023).

The exhaustive and systematic search was carried out in the Scopus, Web of Science, and ProQuest databases via a combination of keywords and the Boolean operators mentioned above. In addition, the search was complemented with a search in Google Scholar. Potentially relevant studies were selected by reading titles and abstracts, and eligibility criteria were applied to the full texts. The qualitative data from the studies were subsequently synthesized via the meta-synthesis method. Finally, the emerging themes, concepts, or theories of the studies were identified, and the relationships between them were established (Medina-Zuta et al., 2023).

The search process initially yielded 846 documents, of which, once the PRISMA methodology was applied, 99 were eliminated because they were duplicated. In this first process, 747 articles were identified, of which 200 were excluded for being outside the time stipulated in the study and 150 for being in a language other than those indicated. From this screening, 397 articles passed the suitability phase, of which 196 were excluded for not presenting methodological quality and 181 for not being empirical studies, articles, or gray literature. Finally, after this process, only 20 articles were included for review (see Figure 1).

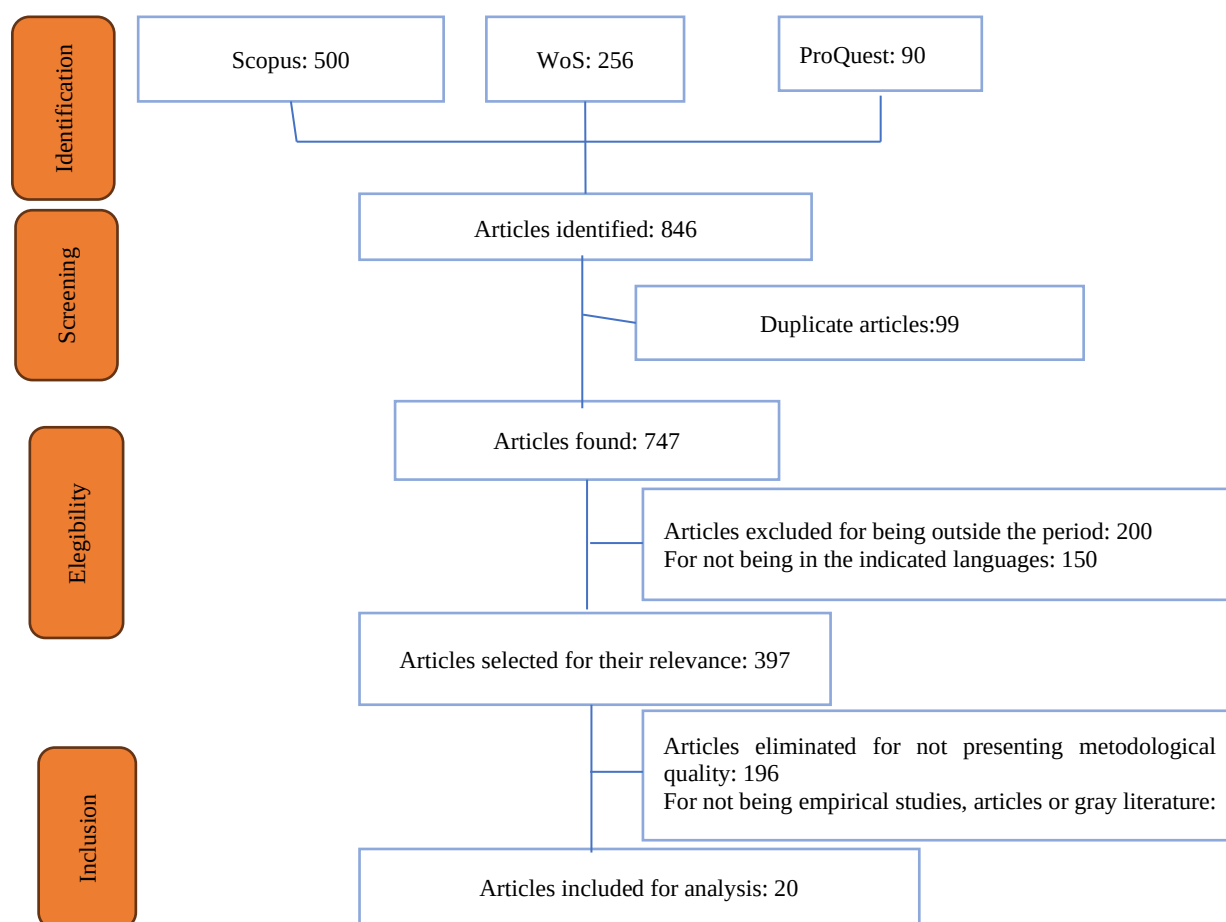


Figure 1 Prism flowchart.

3. Results

Once the search process was completed, the results of the study were tabulated. First, the qualitative results are presented according to the author, year of publication, document title, language, database, methodology applied and the journal responsible for publication. Table 1 summarizes the characteristics of the documents examined.

Table 1 Publication data of the reviewed documents.

Author/year	Title	Language	Database	Methodology	Journal
Dias et al. (2020)	Developing poor communities through creativity tourism	English	Scopus	Qualitative	Journal of Tourism and Cultural Change,
Magadán and Rivas (2018)	Innovation, Creativity and Tourism	English	Scopus	Qualitative (Literature review)	The Emerald Handbook of Entrepreneurship in Tourism, Travel and Hospitality Sustainability
Marujo et al. (2021)	Strategies for creative tourism activities in pandemic contexts: the case of the 'Saídas de Mestre' project.	English	Scopus	Qualitative (Case studies)	Economies
Varotsis (2022)	Digital entrepreneurship and creative industries in tourism: a research agenda.	English	ProQuest/Scopus	Qualitative (Literature review)	STEPS. Tourism and Cultural Heritage Magazine
Olbrich and Fusté-Forné (2023)	When Tourism becomes a game: gamification in cultural tourism in Catalonia	Spanish	ProQuest/Scopus	Qualitative	Turismo em Análise Magazine - RTA
Silva et al. (2021)	Creative tourism on the political agenda: possibilities to contribute to the sustainable development goals.	Portuguese	ProQuest	Qualitative	Island Studies Journal,
Baixinho et al. (2023)	Sustainable creative tourism in the islands and the pandemic: the Creatour Azores Project	English	Scopus/Web of Science/ProQuest	Qualitative	International Journal of Entrepreneurial Behavior & Research
Bakas et al. (2018).	Creative tourism: catalyzing networks of artisanal entrepreneurs in rural Portugal	English	Scopus	Qualitative	Journal of Sustainable Tourism
Nieuwland and Lavanga (2021)	The consequences of being "the capital of cool". Creative entrepreneurs and the sustainable development of creative tourism in the urban context of Rotterdam.	English	Scopus	Qualitative	Current Issues in Tourism
Mohammadi et al. (2018).	The business model and balanced scorecard in creative tourism: the ultimate strategy driver	English	ProQuest/Scopus	Mixed	Urban Forum
Booyens and Rogerson (2015)	Creative tourism in Cape Town: An innovation perspective	English	ProQuest/Scopus	Qualitative (Case study)	Journal of Tourism Management Research
Al-Ababneh (2019)	Creative cultural tourism as a new model of cultural tourism	English	WoS	Qualitative (Literature Review)	Sustainability
Carvalho et al. (2023)	Creative tourism consumption: framing the creative habitus through a Bourdieusian lens.	English	Scopus	Qualitative	Journal of Tourism & Development
Duarte et al. (2022)	Creative Tourism as a promoter of the Sustainable Development Goals - Central Alentejo	English	Scopus	Qualitative (Literature review)	Sustainability
Antunes et al (2023)	Measuring entrepreneurship in sustainable tourism lifestyle. Guidance to improve the tourism experience	English	ProQuest/Scopus	Mixed	Creativity studies
Dias and Azambuja (2022)	Fostering destination creativity through tourism lifestyle entrepreneurship: exploring the	English	Scopus	Quantitative	

	moderating effect of financial orientation.				
Pareti and García (2020)	Matadero-Franklin neighborhood, from a popular market to an artistic-cultural neighborhood. Conservation and capitalization, through creative tourism and cocreation.	Spanish	Scopus/WoS	Qualitative	ACE: Architecture, City and Environment
Li and Kovacs (2021)	Creative tourism and creative shows in China	English	Scopus	Qualitative	Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Management Sustainability
Duxbury et al. (2021)	Creative models of tourism development toward sustainable and regenerative tourism	English	Scopus	Qualitative	
Sarantou et al. (2021)	Context mapping for creative tourism	English	Scopus	Qualitative (Case Study)	Annals of Tourism Research

Among the 20 papers included in the review, 17 were qualitative, 2 were mixed, and only 1 was quantitative, as shown in Figure 2.

With respect to the years of publication, 2021 presented the highest number of publications referring to creative tourism, with 30% (6). It was followed by 2023 with 20% (4), 2018 and 2022 with 15% (3) each, 2020 with 10% (2), and 2019 with 5% (1) each. This is shown in Table 2, which also shows the participation of each journal according to the frequency of publications. Thus, the journal Sustainability has the greatest presence, with four publications, whereas the other 17 journals contributed one publication each. Regarding the language of the publications, 17 were in English, 2 were in Spanish, and one was in Portuguese, as shown in Figure 3.

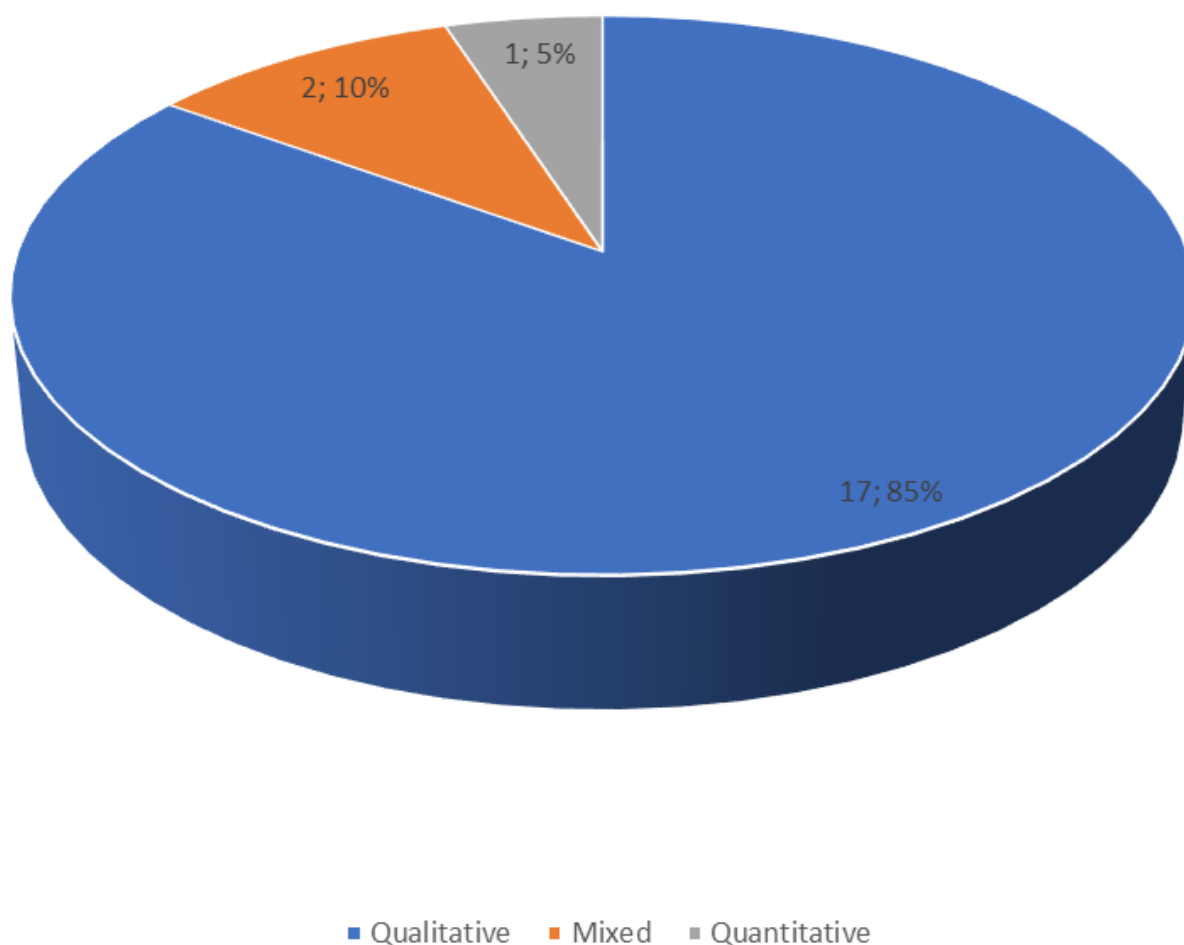


Figure 2 Percentage frequency distribution according to the methodological approach.

Table 2 Publication frequency by year and journal.

N°	Journal	Year of publication											Total
		2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	
1	Sustainability								2		2		4
2	Journal of Tourism and Cultural Change,							1					1
3	The Emerald Handbook of Entrepreneurship in Tourism, Travel and Hospitality					1							1
4	Economies									1			1
5	PASOS. Revista de Turismo y Patrimonio Cultural										1		1
6	Revista Turismo em Análise - RTA								1				1
7	Island Studies Journal										1		1
8	International Journal of Entrepreneurial Behavior & Research					1							1
9	Journal of Sustainable Tourism								1				1
10	Current Issues in Tourism					1							1
11	Urban Forum		1										1
12	Journal of Tourism Management Research						1						1
13	Journal of Tourism & Development									1			1
14	Creativity studies									1			1
15	ACE: Architecture, City and Environment							1					1
16	Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Management								1				1
17	Annals of Tourism Research								1				1
Total		0	1	0	0	3	1	2	6	3	4	0	20

The papers examined showed the position of their authors concerning the definition of creative tourism. Table 3 presents a synthesis of these papers with their respective authors and conceptualization. These definitions—descriptions of creative tourism—were presented on the basis of the definition offered by Richards and Raymond (2000). On the basis of this definition, the authors presented their definitions, which highlighted aspects such as experience, participation, promotion strategies, culture, education, society, and local environments, among many others. Each of these factors is important for the development of this field of knowledge.

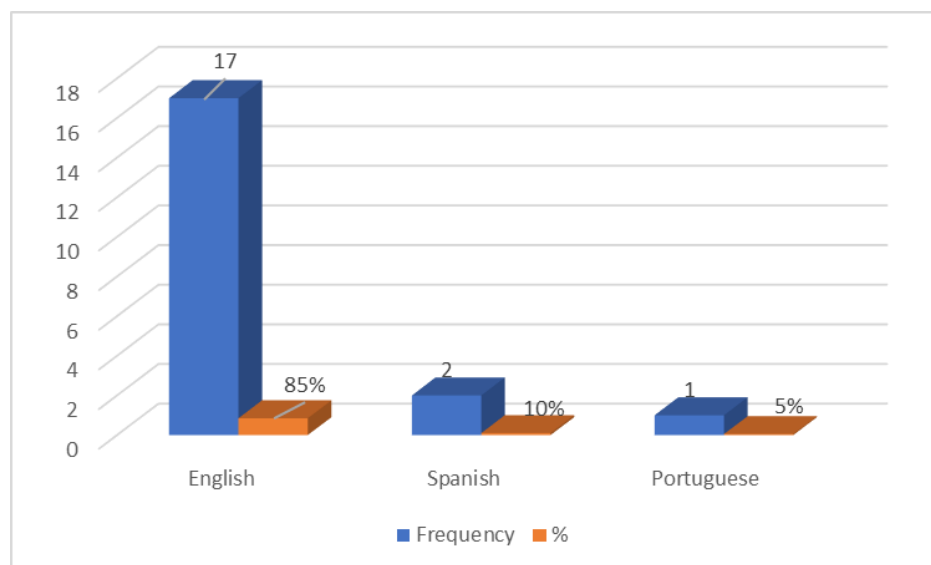
**Figure 3** Percentage distribution of frequency by language.

Table 3 Semantic analysis: the concept of creative tourism.

Authors	Definition of creative tourism
Unesco (2006)	In this kind of tourism, the visitor interacts in an educational, emotional, social, and participatory way with the place, its culture, and its natives. In these destinations, tourists feel like citizens.
De Bruin and Jelinčić (2016).	In both theory and practice, creative tourism reflects a broader "creative turn" within society, representing a significant shift in tourism studies and marking a departure from traditional mass cultural tourism.
Mazarrasa (2016)	The tourist is an active subject in the experience, he/she gets involved in it, does something, and creates something, which brings him/her greater satisfaction.
Pérez and Lois (2016)	Creative tourism encompasses the creation of experiences and the active involvement of customers in the production of these experiences. In reality, it is about consuming culture, but in a more participatory way (interaction, learning, elaboration).
Silva et al. (2021)	Creative tourism has been understood as a modality that highlights the relational aspect of travel and allows connecting people and places through participatory activities that stimulate the creativity of those involved.
Booyens and Rogerson (2015)	Creative tourism emphasizes tourists engaging in experiential activities that allow them to authentically and memorably participate in the genuine cultural life of their destinations.
Al-Ababneh (2019)	Creative tourism can be integrated with various promotional strategies to establish unique tourism destinations, such as through creative classes, creative cities, and creative industries. The appeal of creativity—its atmosphere, content, and activities—has grown alongside the rise of creative events and culture, both of which are strongly supported by tourism.
Remoaldo and Cadima-Ribeiro (2019).	At its core, creative tourism focuses on creativity, local culture, cocreation with local communities, active engagement with places, and authentic experiences, contributing to both local and regional development.
Carvalho et al. (2023)	Creative tourism is regarded as sustainable because it offers immersive and authentic experiences as an alternative to mass tourism, emphasizing cocreation in the design and enjoyment of learning and creative activities.
Serrano-Leyva et al. (2022)	Creative tourism is based on "experiencing". Thus, it becomes the interactive successor of cultural tourism.
Duxbury et al. (2021)	It can be seen as a response to the rise of "mass cultural tourism" and the increasing desire among travelers to take on more active roles during their journeys.
Sarantou et al. (2021)	Creative tourism encompasses activities where creative individuals facilitate tourism services but may also include simpler experiences like museum visits or souvenir shopping, offering a multisensory approach.
Barrera-Fernandez, and Hernandez-Escampa (2017).	Rooted in sociological and anthropological perspectives, creative tourism views culture as a dynamic set of social codes and behaviors, contrasting with the notion of culture as a static product tied to art and literature history.

As a result of the analysis and systematization of information, the articles were classified according to their thematic profile, since few documents presented creative tourism together with tourism entrepreneurship as an object of study. For each thematic aspect identified, the most important characteristics and aspects that are currently presented are presented to analyse the current state of knowledge.

4. Discussion

4.1. Creative tourism in Latin America

Although creative tourism has important advantages for local economies, little attention has been given to it in Latin America (Remoaldo and Cadima-Ribeiro, 2019; Dias et al. 2020). However, studies such as the one conducted by Dias et al. (2020) present four cases of projects implemented with this type of tourism in two Latin American countries (Peru and Brazil). The activities carried out by local entrepreneurs in these projects met the definition of creative tourism, in which various characteristics of the local community were valued; for example, the projects targeted those living on less than US\$2 per day, the development of creative tourism solutions at the local level, and the degree or dimensions that included entrepreneurial activities.

Given the above, it is necessary to emphasize that creative tourism development in Latin America is important not only for the economic aspect but also because it helps the circulation of local narratives to remain active. This means that sustainability generates an increase in the production of creative projects; in other words, the development of creative tourism

in Latin American companies involves narratives and styles that enrich social representations. In the words of Silva et al. (2021), planning tourism activity is important for the (re)organization of cities since the creative and cultural artefacts that are important for residents and visitors are renewed. The relational dynamics inherent in creative tourism tend to value local knowledge and give new meaning to the urban identity of less privileged places and cultural practices.

Notably, tourists drawn to a destination's creativity tend to seek novel and innovative experiences, indicating an attraction to the intangible aspects of the destination's culture—namely, its living traditions and active participation in local customs. Many tourism projects feature events that contribute to the economic and cultural vibrancy of cities (Silva et al., 2021; Nieuwland and Lavanga, 2021; Duxbury et al., 2021). In Latin America, a variety of distinctive behaviors can be observed. While these events provide tourists with enriching experiences, they can also strain public services due to the urban impacts of a large influx of visitors, as seen during events such as the Cervantino International Festival in Mexico (Barrera-Fernández and Hernández-Escampa, 2017).

4.2. *Development of the tourism enterprise*

The reviewed studies highlight the importance of fostering the establishment of businesses that offer tourism activities capable of driving both local and national transformation. This is because, compared with other economic sectors, tourism generates greater income while enabling local residents to engage in entrepreneurship by establishing small-scale tourism enterprises (Al-Ababneh, 2019; Silva et al., 2021; Dias et al., 2020).

Tourism entrepreneurs play a pivotal role in tourism development, as their entrepreneurial spirit stimulates local economic activity. They provide visitors with opportunities to engage in unique experiences that go beyond merely exploring sites, allowing them to actively participate in local activities (Marujo et al., 2021; Silva et al., 2021). Consequently, small-scale tourism ventures are considered more viable for entrepreneurs with limited financial resources.

The advancement of creative tourism, however, requires an entrepreneurial, creative, and innovative mindset. This is due to the competitive, dynamic, and ever-changing nature of global markets shaped by shifting consumer preferences and attitudes (Magadán and Rivas, 2018). Cities and regions are increasingly becoming hubs for social and cultural development, driving growth at the local, regional, and state levels. To excel in the global network of cities, skilled professionals, experts, and investors are essential.

Marujo et al. (2021) emphasized that the supply structure of creative tourism remains intact because it is grounded in sustainable development principles, relying on local resources and agents that are easily accessible. As such, creative tourism has been recognized as a strategy for the physical, cultural, and social regeneration of destinations. Furthermore, analysing creative tourism initiatives helps assess the competitiveness of a destination.

Varotsis (2022) underlines that the sustainability of tourist destinations and quality of life are crucial for successful creative entrepreneurship. He advocates activities tied to digital and creative entrepreneurship in tourism, stressing the importance of adopting digital tools for managing and promoting creative tourism services.

Finally, the COVID-19 pandemic has caused significant disruptions to the tourism sector, yet it has inadvertently benefited cultural and creative tourism in peripheral, rural, and remote island areas. These locations offer advantages such as isolation, low population density, and perceived safety. Encouraging longer tourist stays in less-visited locations, especially during off-peak seasons, supports small-scale creative tourism and promotes more sustainable local activities (Baixinho et al., 2023).

4.3. *Strategies used in creative tourism for the development of tourism enterprises*

When we discuss sustainable and successful business models, we mean that they are designed to include innovations, which reduce costs and increase the efficiency of operations. Therefore, implementing innovation strategies makes providing services more convenient because it means establishing courses of action, activities, and a deliberate organization to create and maintain competitive advantage. Many of these strategies refer to projects that have an impact on diversification in creative tourism activities, managing to create an attractive destination in regions that do not have a traditional tourism environment (Dias et al., 2020; Mansilla, 2021).

A notable example of a project that has served as an effective strategy is the national Creatour initiative in Portugal, which has gained recognition both nationally and internationally. This project inspired the Portuguese Association of Local Development, Marca, to launch the Saídas de Mestre project. Focusing on creative tourism activities, the project aimed to highlight the intangible heritage of small rural areas. Specifically, it leveraged the rich intangible heritage of the Alentejo region to offer experiential, educational, and creative activities that actively involved visitors while adhering to the health and safety guidelines set by Marca. This type of tourism emphasizes not only the creative experiences of tourists but also meaningful engagement with the local culture (Marujo et al., 2021).

Dias et al. (2020) examined four projects, two in Peru and two in Brazil, and demonstrated that impoverished populations in both countries have the potential to develop creative tourism activities (refer to Table 4). However, this process is not straightforward, as significant barriers hinder these communities' ability to alleviate poverty—an essential challenge in

the areas studied. The intervention of foreign companies was identified as a key factor in overcoming these obstacles. Although the study could not quantify the economic impact of creative tourism in these communities, it showed that creative tourism serves as a sustainable platform for local entrepreneurship.

Other strategies used consisted of the use of a dynamic package platform on specific websites, offering hotels that have a solarium terrace, a suspended glass pool, and a heated pool with a retractable covered spa, equipped with a sauna, Turkish bath, heated Jacuzzi and shower. In addition, something that stood out was the proposal for hotels for specific sectors of the population, for example, millennials or Generation X (Magadán and Rivas, 2018).

The gamified tourism analysed by Olbrich and Fusté-Forné (2023) is a strategy used by creative tourism to reach a different audience, ignoring the idea that games are only for children. Experience providers have this tool to change tourism, and together with gamification, the visitor becomes the protagonist and can create and participate in a memorable experience. Gamification in tourism experiences allows the visitor to be motivated, to become a participant, and to generate an experience linked to learning and discovery (or rediscovery) of a place or culture. Thus, it is possible to assert that the experiences provided by gamification favour cocreation since the player is the one who establishes what the experience will be like (Olbrich and Fusté-Forné 2023).

Table 4 Strategies applied to creative tourism.

Study	Strategies	Site characteristics and implementation results
Developing poor communities through creativity in tourism. (Dias et al., 2020)	Projects: two in Peru (Poverty Reduction and Alleviation Project and Haku Wiñay) and two in Brazil (Rio Preguiças and Lagoas).	BRAZIL: A poor community hosting creative tourism activities demonstrated high entrepreneurial spirit. They adapted agricultural practices by introducing new production techniques and diversifying income streams. This led to opportunities such as river excursions, diving, community-based tourism, and gastronomy featuring tourist participation. PERU: A poor community engaging in creative tourism activities also exhibited high entrepreneurial energy. The initiative aimed to reduce poverty by creating jobs and including small-scale producers. Approximately 2,400 small producers received training in creativity, environmental protection, and biodiversity conservation, contributing to increased family income.
Innovation, Creativity and Tourism (Magadán and Rivas, 2018).	Dynamic package platform on the brand's website. Solarium terrace, with the first suspended glass swimming pool and a heated pool with retractable cover in its spa, equipped with sauna, Turkish bath, heated Jacuzzi, and rain shower. Hotels for millennials. New hotel brands are available for Generation X, such as NH Collection or El Uno (H10 group).	In the three cases examined, the implementation of creative ideas implemented in some hotels in different locations was evidenced, showing the positive effects of creativity and innovation in the strategies applied to attract different types of visitors.
Strategies for creative tourism activities in pandemic contexts: the case of the Saídas de Mestre project. Marujo et al. (2021).	Saídas de Mestre Project: was born out of the national project Creatour: Development of creative tourist destinations in small towns and rural areas. It consists of a set of holistic experiences of a passive and active nature, which participants can continue to enjoy in the different creative workshops in which they participate.	Alentejo Region Marca adapted its Saídas de Mestre project to the pandemic context by implementing specific strategies. While many planned activities were not possible during this period, those that proceeded were heavily regulated by health and safety protocols. Marca aims to preserve the essence of the project by maintaining its portfolio of experiences, ensuring they continue to reflect the five types of experiences rooted in intangible heritage.
When Tourism becomes a game: gamification in cultural tourism in Catalonia.	Gamification	Catalonia Gamification or "the use of game elements in nonplayful contexts", used in tourism, is framed in creative tourism; it provides unique and individual

(Olbrich and Fusté -Forné 2023)		experiences, as opposed to mass and standardized tourism products. Gamification is immersed in the experience economy. It became evident that gamification is already part of cultural tourism in Catalonia.
Sustainable creative tourism in the islands and the pandemic: the Creatour Azores Project	Creatour Azores Project	The Azores archipelago The project aimed to catalyze active participation, creative self-expression, interactive learning, and connection with the local community in the Azores. It became evident that the pandemic could benefit development in peripheral, rural areas and remote island landscapes through cultural and creative tourism: the Creatour Azores project is more isolated, less populated, and potentially safer; thus, island status may hold the keys to a more sustainable paradigm shift beyond a simple return to "business as usual".
Creative tourism in Cape Town: An innovation perspective	Creative events, creative venues	Cape Town Creative tourism should extend beyond merely attending events or visiting landmarks tied to the creative industries. Innovation in this field should foster participatory and educational experiences, encouraging deeper engagement with arts, culture, history, urban environments, and social dynamics.
Creative tourism as a new challenge to destination development: The Portuguese case study	Creatour Project: Creative Tourism Development of destinations in small cities and rural areas. Activities related to nature, culture, and gastronomy, following eight itineraries. Mosaic, writing, and drawing. in journalism, bookbinding, woodcarving, ceramics, and creative travel writing. Workshops.	Portugal Representatives from Portuguese institutions and platforms reported that their primary achievement was blending tradition with innovation. They also highlighted the importance of forming partnerships, both locally and internationally.
Matadero-Franklin neighborhood, from a popular market to an artistic-cultural neighborhood. Conservation and capitalization, through creative tourism and cocreation.	Workshops, book presentations, forums, conversations, and conferences to have the presence and participation of all the citizens, consider the neighbors of the neighborhood, tenants, visitors, and universities.	Matadero-Franklin south of Santiago de Chile The Matadero Franklin neighborhood invites creative tourism in both public and private spaces, the streets are spaces used for small businesses on weekends.
Creative tourism and creative shows in China	Festivals and events linked to the seven different categories of resources (crafts and popular art, design, cinema, gastronomy, literature, media arts, music). Creative shows	China Travel blog analyses identified tangible examples of the three core aspects of creative tourism as they relate to creative performances: active participation, gaining knowledge and personal growth, and experiencing diverse cultures.
Creative models of tourism development toward sustainable and regenerative tourism	Project Creatour brought together teams in five research centers and 40 participating organizations ("pilots") to learn, promote and develop a variety of small-scale, site-specific creative tourism initiatives in small towns and rural areas.	North, Center, Alentejo, and Algarve regions of mainland Portugal Creatour's pilot project developers strongly believed that the distinctive cultural elements and unique characteristics of their locations were the foundation for building creative and sustainable tourism. These efforts aimed to benefit the broader community while preserving local culture and heritage.

The use of effective and innovative strategies in creative tourism allows increased promotion and publicity to generate greater consumption and improve the experience of tourists. In addition, creativity plays a leading role in creative tourism development strategies; hence, the strategies used in the framework of tourism comprise resources, meaning, and creativity as a whole.

5. Final Considerations

The review highlights the growing importance of creativity in every one of the strategies used to promote the development and creation of spaces that allow new experiences for tourists. In this context, creative tourism requires more cities and regions to develop tourism businesses or ventures. However, it is necessary to note that each case is different and that such developments depend largely on the context; in other words, the design of each project or tourism plan will depend on its location, connectivity, and available asset base.

The focus of the analysis is to create places that favour creative tourism development in a particular area. The holistic approach provided by creativity in creating places that provide new experiences serves as the basis for the elements required in creative tourism design. Hence, each study examined has shown a variety of environments that constitute places that bring together tangible and intangible resources of great value in linking the local to creative activity.

When the diversity of resources offered by a tourist destination is taken advantage of and effective strategies are implemented, it is possible to develop the entrepreneurial potential of a population. In this way, tourism becomes an excellent alternative for towns and unknown areas to diversify their activities. Through this process, small-scale initiatives are born that offer genuine experiences to the visitor and further enhance the tourism reputation of the region. Finally, long-awaited sustainability is a consequence of recreational tourism activities, which contribute to preserving the environment, local traditions, and cultural identity.

Ethical Considerations

Not applicable.

Conflict of Interest

The authors declare that they have no conflicts of interest.

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